The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Sundas, the 11th of Frostfall (Sunday, October 11, 2026) · Morning Edition — Vol. 2610, No. 11 · Price: One Septim



Gandy keeps his grump dry under the eaves while Maevy conducts the rain.

Skies o'er the Hold

61° / 54°

Heavy thunderstorms — Flood Watch until Mon 5 AM; Wind Advisory 8 AM–8 PM

Sunrise 6:27 AM · Sunset 5:55 PM

Tomorrow — Rain, 59/51

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday · *Tonight* · *Tomorrow*

New Moon

waxing toward the full moon

11th of Frostfall = October 11

Months run one-for-one all year

Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

A Stormy Sundas: Quilts, Chili, and the Last Fair Day

Payson, Ariz.

PAYSON — Hail, travelers! Sundas dawned grey and growling over the Mogollon Rim, the storm drumming the pines while the Holds made merry indoors: today is the last day of the Rim Country Quilt Round-Up in Payson, the Fall & Antique Festival's chili cook-off in Pine, and Fort Verde Days' homecoming celebration down in Camp Verde. Keep an eye on the sky — a Flood Watch holds till Monday's small hours — and keep the week in your sights, for the days ahead bring trail-building, folk songs, the town council's gathering on Wednesday, and the Payson Art League's ARToberFest filling the weekend. By the Nine, there's no weather too wild for Rim Country doings.



A market fair beneath the pines: quilts on the line, chili on the fire, and pumpkins by the antique stall.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**

  — Rim Country Quilt Round-Up — Last day today. The quilt guild's autumn gathering fills the Mazatzal Hotel & Casino Event Center with quilting classes and displays of fine stitchery — rows of finished quilts, demonstrations, and vendors for the fabric-minded. Wander the aisles for an hour or a day; quilters are the friendliest folk in the Hold. (Runs Friday through today, Sunday, Oct. 11.)

  — ACA Race #3 // Ubuntu Trail — The Arizona Cycling Association's scholastic mountain-bike series rolls into the Payson Event Center and Ubuntu Trail area today, with the first races off at 8 AM and awards late in the afternoon. Middle- and high-school racers from across the North Conference take on the course while families cheer from the sidelines. Come watch the future of Rim Country riding.

- **Pine-Strawberry**

  — Annual Fall & Antique Festival — Last day today, 9 AM–4 PM at the Pine-Strawberry Community Center, 3886 N Hwy 87 in Pine. A chili cook-off, food and craft vendors, a pumpkin patch, and an antique show inside the Cultural Hall — the twin villages' autumn send-off in one stop. Come hungry; leave with something old. (Runs Saturday and Sunday, Oct. 10–11.)

- **Camp Verde**

  — Fort Verde Days — Last day today of Camp Verde's big annual homecoming, the town's celebration of the frontier military post it grew up around. Sunday brings vendors, entertainment, and living-history events at Fort Verde State Historic Park, 646 S. 1st Street — admission free. Saturday's parade has passed, but the old camp's story carries the day. (Runs Friday through Sunday, Oct. 9–11.)

- **Sedona**

  — Sedona Community Farmers Market — Sundays, now on winter hours: 11 AM–3 PM at the Wells Fargo parking lot, 2201 W SR 89A, weekly through May 30, 2027. Local growers, bakers, and makers set out their tables for the valley's regular Sunday trade. Worth the drive for the fresh bread alone.

  — Alternative Firing 1-Day Workshop with CJ Henderson — 10 AM at 15 Art Barn Rd. A hands-on day of pottery finishing techniques — raku-style alternative firings that coax fire-born color from the clay. All skill levels welcome; take home something the kiln gods smiled on.

- **Prescott**

  — Prescott History Tour — 10 AM. A two-hour guided walk through downtown Prescott with guides who know the streets and the folk who shaped them. Territorial capital tales, Whiskey Row lore, and the buildings that outlived them all.

  — Flashback — LIVE at Whiskey River Tavern — 1 PM at 214 S. Montezuma St. A retro and classic cover band keeps the afternoon singing and dancing. Come for the sing-along crowd; bring your best air guitar.

  — La Posada – Stage to Screen — 3 PM at the Prescott Elks Theater, 117 E Gurley St. Missed the stage production? See it on screen with archival photographs tracing the history. A quiet, lovely way to spend a stormy afternoon.

The Days Ahead

- **Monday, Oct. 12**

  — Open Mic Night: Music with a Purpose — 4 PM at THAT Brewery & Pub, 3270 N Hwy 87, Pine. The community open mic in the pines where every donation gives back locally. Bring an instrument or just your voice; the forest provides the acoustics.

  — Mud Run, Schnebly Hill — Noon start at the bottom of Schnebly Hill near Sedona. A rowdy off-road run up the famous red-rock route. Spectators welcome at the base; runners should bring their bravest boots.

- **Tuesday, Oct. 13**

  — Trail Day Volunteer Build — 7 AM at Hwy 87, Pine. Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction calls hikers, bikers, and runners to build trail — "don't just use the trail, help build it." Gloves, water, and stout boots; breakfast of champions optional but recommended.

- **Wednesday, Oct. 14**

  — Willow Lake Guided Walk — 3 PM. An easy walk around Willow Lake's south side with wildlife expert Walt Anderson and butterfly enthusiast Becky Hardy. Sturdy shoes and layered dress; the cottonwoods are turning. Also that day: the Willow Lake Management Plan open house, 4–6 PM at the Phippen Museum.

- **Thursday, Oct. 15**

  — A Band Called Honalee — 7 PM, Payson High School Auditorium, 301 S. McLane Rd. A folk trio reliving Peter, Paul & Mary — "Leaving on a Jet Plane," "Blowin' in the Wind," "Puff the Magic Dragon" — plus Dylan, Joni Mitchell, and the Mamas & the Papas. An evening of harmony under the auditorium lights.

  — Gary Allan — 7:30 PM, Findlay Toyota Center, 3201 N. Main Street, Prescott Valley. The country headliner takes the stage with a special guest. Tickets moving; worth the drive down the mountain for the faithful.

- **Friday, Oct. 16**

  — 3rd Friday Art Walk — 4–6 PM on Main Street, Camp Verde. Galleries and shops open their doors for a free evening stroll. Meet the makers, sip something warm, and watch the street turn gallery.

— ARToberFest — Friday through Sunday at the Mazatzal Casino Event Center. The Payson Art League's annual fine art and fine craft show and sale, with the Payson Jazz Trio and an art raffle benefiting local school art programs. The Hold's artists, all in one hall.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — the sconces must be drawn and readied before a single torch can burn.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue since Oct. 3 — the printers stand ready; give them their orders.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue since yesterday — hang the finished torches and light the way.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Due Saturday, Oct. 17 — the Hearth's arms take shape; mount it by the front door after.

The shield must rise by Saturday — but the torches, long overdue, claim first right.



Sconces, torches, and the Hearth shield — the craft board awaits its smith.

Word from the Payson Hold



The **Payson Town Council** holds its regular meeting on **Wednesday, Oct. 14, at 4:00 PM** in the Town Hall Council Chambers, 303 N Beeline Hwy. The agenda packet had not yet been posted when this edition went to press — the town posts agendas at least 24 hours ahead, so the packet should appear by Tuesday.

Watch for it at the town's meetings & agendas page, where agendas, minutes, and the meeting recording are posted as they become available. Council normally gathers at 4:00 PM on the 2nd and 4th Wednesdays.

Merchant of the Hold

Scoops Ice Cream & Espresso · *Payson*



A frothy pour at Scoops — close enough to a mead-hall pour to fool a Nord.

A full espresso bar and ice-cream parlor on historic Main Street — fresh-roasted organic coffee, lattes, mochas, and cappuccinos alongside 24 flavors of Blue Bell ice cream, shakes, sundaes, and homemade pastries. Free Wi-Fi, chalk tables, and board games make it a proper lingering spot, and the kids' activity area keeps the smallfolk content. The Butterbeer Latte — two shots of almond, two of vanilla — arrives like a tankard of sweet tavern mead, foam on top: close enough to a mead-hall pour to fool a Nord, and you'll want to order a second.

> *"Really nice folks here. The hot caramel brulee was tasty for sure with enough kick in a medium to fuel me back to Phoenix."* — Google review (via Trustfeed)

201 W Main St, Suite H, Payson. Mon–Thu 7 AM–8 PM, Fri 7 AM–9 PM, Sat 8 AM–9 PM, Sun 10 AM–8 PM (listings disagree on Sundays — call ahead). (928) 474-3957. Easy on the coin purse: hand-dipped shakes $2.85–$4.25. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: The coziest cup on Main Street — espresso and ice cream under one roof, in the sweet shop the bards call Payson's best.

Tales from the Treeline

The Pie-Dish Regatta



Gus sails his pie-dish raft across the flooded clearing, Flurry at the tow rope.

The storm had turned the Hearth's clearing into a lake, and Gus (a friendly orc with a baker's soul) was having thoughts.

"The pond reaches the porch," he announced, holding his warmest apple pie over his head, "and my pies must reach the porch people. So the pies must sail."

Before Mabel (a wood elf) could finish saying "Gus, no—", he had launched his biggest copper pie dish onto the flood like a raft and climbed aboard, pie held aloft.

Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon), delighted, seized the tow rope in his claws and flapped skyward — which, with his kinked tail, meant a zigzag course straight at the porch, then away from it, then sideways.

"Port! Starboard! No, the OTHER port!" shouted Mabel from the dry porch, waving her arms like a harbormaster.

Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) waded in cheering, and Henny (the Hearth's plump Skyrim-style chicken) perched on the dish's rim like a figurehead, serene as a duchess.

Earl (an elk), dignified and dry beneath the pines, declined to participate. The sky declined to notice. One Flurry loop later, a wave crested the pie dish and crowned Earl's antlers — and the only dry thing in the clearing was the pie, which Gus delivered to the porch without spilling a crumb.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Sundas be free of spiders, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com